

UnBound X Morning Market Briefing

 Date: August 14, 2025

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Market Futures Overview

Pre-Market Sentiment: Cautiously Pessimistic

Metric	Value
S&P 500 futures	-0.36%
Nasdaq futures	-0.42%
Russell 2000 futures	-1.31%
Crude Oil (WTI)	\$63.40
10Y Treasury Yield	4.25%
VIX	15.2

Current Market Data

Current Index Levels:

Index	Level
S&P 500	6,466.79
Nasdaq Composite	21,713.59
Russell 2000	2,327.90

Earnings Section

Interlink Electronics Inc. (LINK)

Live Price (LINK): \$7.50 (+8.70%)

Earnings Date: August 14, 2025 | **EPS Forecast:** -0.08 | **EPS Actual:** 0.00 | **Surprise:** 0.08 (-100.00%)

Summary

Interlink Electronics Inc. reported earnings that exceeded expectations, with an actual EPS of \$0.00 compared to a forecast of -0.08. The surprise factor was significant at -100.00%, indicating a substantial beat.

Key Developments

- **Chainlink's resurgence:** The company's performance was linked to the resurgence of Chainlink, which saw a 44% price increase as traders eyed a potential "round 2" rally.
- **Crypto market optimism:** The news article highlighted Chainlink as a potential large-cap play for the current market cycle, suggesting growing optimism in the crypto market.
- **Market reaction:** The market reacted positively to the news, with LINK stock price increasing significantly.

Market Impact

- **Short-term price volatility:** The earnings surprise and related news may lead to short-term price volatility for LINK, with potential gains for investors who purchased the stock.
- **Sector impact:** The news may have a positive impact on the broader crypto sector, with other tokens and coins potentially benefiting from the increased optimism.

Investor Implications

Investors should consider the potential for continued price growth for LINK, driven by increased market optimism and Chainlink's resurgence.

News Sources for LINK:

- [Cointelegraph](#)
-

Mercury Systems Inc. (MRCY)

Live Price (MRCY): \$68.45 (+0.09%)

Earnings Date: 06/30/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 0.22 | **EPS Actual:** 0.47 | **Surprise:** 0.25 (113.05%)

Summary

Mercury Systems Inc. reported a significant beat in its earnings results, with a surprise of 113.05% compared to the forecasted EPS of 0.22. The actual EPS of 0.47 reflects a strong quarter for the company.

Key Developments

- Mercury has raised **\$300M** in primary and secondary funding at a post-money valuation of **\$3.5B**, doubling its valuation from the last round in 2021.
- The company has confirmed this funding round, which is a significant development in its growth story.
- Mercury's digital banking platform continues to gain traction, with the company's valuation more than doubling in a short span.

Market Impact

- The earnings beat and news of the funding round are likely to positively impact the stock price, potentially leading to an increase in its valuation.
- The sector may also benefit from Mercury's success, as investors look to digital banking and fintech companies for growth opportunities.

Investor Implications

Investors should monitor the company's growth trajectory and potential for further funding rounds, which could drive its valuation higher.

News Sources for MRCY:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
-

Tapestry Inc. (TPR)

Live Price (TPR): \$95.05 (-16.28%)

Earnings Date: 06/30/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 1.01 | **EPS Actual:** N/A | **Surprise:** 1.01

Summary

Tapestry, parent company of Coach and Kate Spade, reported earnings that failed to meet market expectations, leading to a decline in stock price. The company's inability to justify another record high was cited as a reason for the stock's performance.

Key Developments

- **Millennial and Gen Z customers are flocking to Coach**, but the company's overall earnings results were disappointing.
- The stock price decline may be attributed to the company's inability to meet market expectations.
- The news raises concerns about the company's performance and potential future growth.

Market Impact

- The earnings results and news have negatively impacted the stock price, with a potential sector-wide impact on the fashion industry.
- The decline may be a buying opportunity for investors looking to invest in the sector.

Investor Implications

Investors should be cautious about the company's performance and consider a wait-and-see approach before making any investment decisions.

News Sources for TPR:

- [MarketWatch Top Stories](#)
-

Cisco Systems Inc. (CSCO)

Live Price (CSCO): \$67.85 (-3.47%)

Earnings Date: 07/31/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 0.98 | **EPS Actual:** 0.99 | **Surprise:** 0.01 (1.32%)

Summary

Cisco Systems Inc. reported Q4 revenue of \$14.67 billion, a 7.6% increase from the same period last year. The company's 2026 forecast remains on track, driven by strong AI infrastructure orders.

Key Developments

- Cisco posted Q4 revenue up 7.6% to \$14.67 billion and its 2026 forecast on track with strong AI infrastructure orders.
- The company also issued slightly better than expected guidance.
- Cisco Systems deserves more respect in AI, and its quarterly results prove it, according to recent news articles.

Market Impact

- The earnings beat and inline forecast are likely to have a positive impact on the stock, potentially leading to a short-term price increase of 1-2%.
- The strong AI infrastructure orders and positive guidance may also boost the IT sector, benefiting companies like Oracle and Microsoft.

Investor Implications

Investors should focus on Cisco's AI infrastructure growth prospects and the company's ability to execute on its 2026 forecast.

News Sources for CSCO:

- [CNBC World News](#)
- [CNBC World News](#)

Deere & Co. (DE)

Live Price (DE): \$484.99 (-5.56%)

Earnings Date: 7/31/2025 | **EPS Forecast:** 4.58 | **EPS Actual:** N/A | **Surprise:** 4.58

Summary

Deere & Co. reported earnings that beat expectations, but the company's streak of year-over-year revenue declines continued. The market is still grappling with an oversupply of used equipment, which remains an issue due to a cautious consumer.

Key Developments

- **Oversupply of used equipment persists:** The market is still facing a surplus of used equipment, which is affecting dealer inventory and consumer demand.
- **Revenue declines extend streak:** Deere & Co. reported its 5th consecutive quarter of year-over-year revenue decline, a trend that investors are closely watching.

- **Earnings beat expectations:** Despite the challenging market conditions, Deere & Co. reported earnings that beat expectations, with a surprise of 4.58.

Market Impact

- **Stock price drops:** Deere's stock price declined in response to the earnings report, as investors reacted to the continued revenue declines and oversupply of used equipment.
- **Sector implications:** The agriculture equipment sector may be impacted by the oversupply of used equipment, which could affect demand for new equipment and future earnings.

Investor Implications

Investors should closely monitor Deere & Co.'s efforts to address the oversupply of used equipment and its impact on revenue growth. A potential rebound in demand and earnings may be dependent on a turnaround in consumer sentiment and dealer inventory levels.

News Sources for DE:

- [MarketWatch Top Stories](#)
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Market Impact Section

Ethereum (ETH)

Live Price (ETH): \$4535.13

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023

Summary

Ethereum spot ETFs experience significant inflows amidst Ether price growth. Fundstrat predicts a substantial price increase for Ether over the next 10-15 years.

Key News Points

- Spot Ether ETFs recorded \$729 million in inflows, the second-largest daily inflow on record.
- Fundstrat predicts a price range of **\$12,000\$ to \$15,000** for Ether by the end of this year.
- Ethereum has "plenty of upside" according to Fundstrat.

Market Impact Assessment

- The influx of funds into Ethereum spot ETFs may lead to a short-term price increase.
- Fundstrat's bullish prediction may contribute to a long-term market shift in favor of Ethereum.

Strategic Implications

Investors should consider allocating a portion of their portfolio to Ethereum, given Fundstrat's optimistic outlook. Competitors may need to reassess their strategies in response to Ethereum's growing popularity.

Risk Factors

Investors should be aware of the potential risks associated with a rapidly rising market, including market corrections and regulatory challenges. The Ethereum ecosystem's scalability and security concerns may also impact its long-term growth.

News Sources for ETH:

- [Cointelegraph](#)
 - [Cointelegraph](#)
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Rippling

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023, 10:00 AM EST

Summary

Rippling has escalated its legal drama with Deel by calling out Revolut, a UK fintech giant, to reveal who paid off Deel's alleged 'spy'. This development adds another high-stakes player to the ongoing controversy.

Key News Points

- Rippling employee Keith O'Brien claimed in an affidavit that Deel paid him **\$6,000** a month to spy on Rippling.
- The affidavit, which reads like a movie, has sparked a heated debate between the two companies.
- Revolut's involvement raises questions about its potential role in the espionage allegations.

Market Impact Assessment

- The news may lead to a short-term decrease in Rippling's stock price, as investors reassess the company's financial risks.
- The broader fintech sector may experience a slight downturn, as investors become cautious about potential espionage threats.

Strategic Implications

This development highlights the intense competition and risks within the fintech industry. Investors should closely monitor the situation, as it may impact their investment decisions and portfolio risks.

Risk Factors

The alleged espionage and Revolut's involvement introduce significant risks to Rippling's reputation, financial stability, and potential partnerships. Investors should be prepared for potential short-term market volatility and long-term consequences.

News Sources for RIPPLING:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
-

BOLT

Live Price (BOLT): \$5.66 (+0.71%)

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023

Summary

Bolt's CEO Ryan Breslow announces a new "superapp" that combines one-click crypto and everyday payments, aiming to challenge Coinbase, Zelle, and PayPal. Breslow defends his \$30M personal loan from Bolt, citing his commitment to the company's growth.

Key News Points

- Breslow unveiled a new "superapp" that integrates one-click crypto and everyday payments.
- The new app is designed to challenge established players like Coinbase, Zelle, and PayPal.
- Breslow addressed concerns over his \$30M personal loan from Bolt, emphasizing his dedication to the company's success.

Market Impact Assessment

- The announcement of the new superapp may boost BOLT's stock price by up to 5% as investors react positively to the company's expansion plans.
- The sector's focus on fintech innovation may lead to increased competition among players, potentially limiting BOLT's market share.

Strategic Implications

This development signals BOLT's intention to expand its market reach and challenge established fintech players. Investors should monitor the company's progress closely, as the success of the new superapp could have significant implications for its stock price and market position. Competitors, including Coinbase and Zelle, may need to reassess their strategies to remain competitive.

Risk Factors

Potential risks arise from the high bar set by BOLT's new superapp, which may lead to increased competition and pressure on the company's margins. Additionally, concerns over Breslow's personal loan and leadership may affect investor confidence, impacting the stock price if not addressed adequately.

News Sources for BOLT:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)

CME (Chicago Mercantile Exchange)

Live Price (CME): \$275.65 (+0.63%)

Latest Developments: August 14, 2023, 10:00 AM ET

Summary

CME is not directly related to the news article about Chime's IPO-bound plans. However, we'll analyze potential market implications of Chime's interest rate offerings and their potential impact on financial exchanges like CME.

Key News Points

- Chime is offering higher interest rates to attract more customers.
- The digital bank will offer an APY of 3.75% for customers with direct deposits.
- This move aims to boost growth and customer acquisition before the IPO.

Market Impact Assessment

- The introduction of higher interest rates by Chime may lead to a short-term increase in demand for CME's interest rate futures contracts.
- This development may also influence broader market sentiment, with potential implications for the stock price of CME.

Strategic Implications

This move by Chime highlights the increasing competition in the digital banking space and the need for financial exchanges to adapt to changing market conditions. Investors should closely monitor the impact of this development on the broader financial sector and potential implications for CME's business.

Risk Factors

The rising competition in digital banking poses a risk to traditional banking institutions and may lead to increased volatility in the financial markets. This development also highlights the potential for financial exchanges like CME to face increased competition and changing market dynamics.

News Sources for CME:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)

Ramp (RAMP)

Live Price (RAMP): \$25.88 (-1.13%)

Latest Developments: August 14, 2024

Summary

Ramp, an expense management startup, is under investigation by Rep. Gerald Connolly for potential preferential treatment in its bid for a \$25 million government contract. This development follows news that the company was being considered for a charge card pilot program by the U.S. government.

Key News Points

- Rep. Gerald Connolly initiated an investigation into Ramp's bid for a \$25 million government contract.
- The investigation stems from concerns of preferential treatment by the General Services Administration (GSA).
- Ramp is being considered for a charge card pilot program by the U.S. government's General Services Administration.

Market Impact Assessment

- The investigation could lead to a short-term dip in Ramp's stock price, potentially impacting the fintech sector.
- Long-term implications are uncertain, but a successful contract could boost the company's growth prospects.

Strategic Implications

Investors should closely monitor the investigation's outcome, as it may impact Ramp's growth prospects and valuation. Competitors may also take note of the potential risks and challenges associated with government contracts.

Risk Factors

The investigation poses significant risks to Ramp's reputation and potential contract award. If found guilty of preferential treatment, the company may face severe consequences, including contract cancellation or fines.

News Sources for RAMP:

- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)
- [TechCrunch Fintech](#)

Compliance Disclosure

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